

endures long enough. In that year, 1907, the size of the National City Bank was regarded as phenomenal in America, and more than impressive in London, Paris, Berlin and St. Petersburg. We had in our own vaults as our lawful reserves more than \$40,000,000—and three-quarters of that sum was in gold. On our books were sums representing millions due us from other banks; we had paper that represented nearly \$120,000,000 of loans and discounts; we had many other millions in the form of Government bonds; every day we held possession of pieces of paper representing millions of dollars which were expressed on our books as “exchanges for clearing house.” In August, 1907, we were a fabulous organism.

Our total resources were:

\$231,455,057.07

But, of course, our liabilities were:

\$231,455,057.07

If it was a big, strong beast, it was a gentle one, and I was one of its mahouts, charged with responsibility for its well-being, its continued existence, its further growth. You can bet I worried as the nation became infected with fear-madness.

Although the depositors never gathered as a mob outside our bank, I knew the flavor of terror just from contemplating the possibility.

The Roosevelt in the White House at that time was Theodore, and his policies and behavior were thoroughly obnoxious to the orthodox financial group. They called him a demagogue, and he, for his part, threatened dire things. Once he threatened to take over the coal-mines as a way to